VLAN

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VLAN (Virtual Local Area Network) is a logical grouping of devices within a network that allows segmentation of a physical LAN into separate broadcast domains.

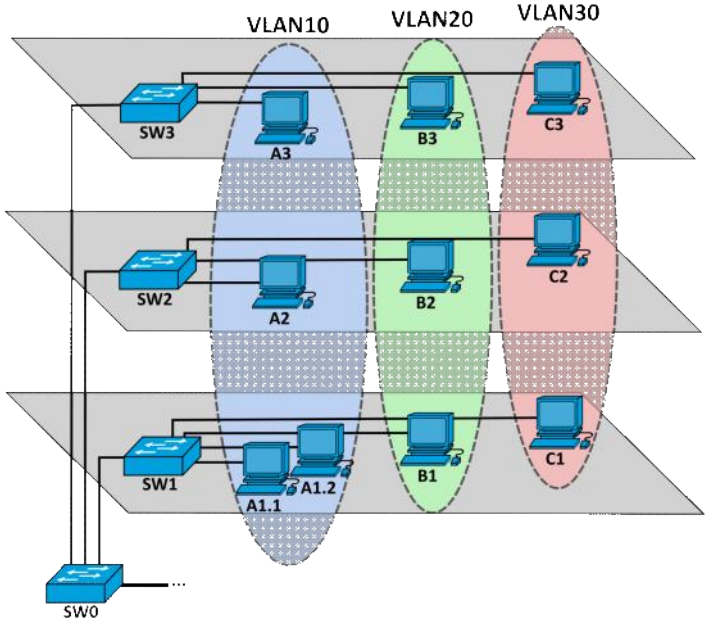
Instead of being limited by physical location, devices in the same VLAN can communicate as if they are on the same network, even if they are connected to different switches.

Key points:

Improves network security by isolating traffic

Reduces broadcast traffic and improves performance

Provides better network management and flexibility

Each VLAN is identified by a unique VLAN ID (1–4094)

Example:
In a company, the HR department and the IT department can be placed in different VLANs on the same switch so their traffic stays separated.